

GUIDANCE DIRECTIVE: STUDENT WORKLOAD UNDER THE CREDIT-MODULE SYSTEM

Issued under the oversight of the Vice-Rector for Academic Affairs

1. Purpose and Legal Basis

This directive defines how student workload is calculated, recorded, and communicated under the credit-module system, and sets out the responsibilities of faculty, the Educational-Methodological Department, and academic advisors in applying it consistently. It is issued under the oversight of the Vice-Rector for Academic Affairs so that all departments, module coordinators, and students work from one standard when planning curricula, syllabi, and assessment.

The workload framework rests on:

1. Resolution of the Cabinet of Ministers of the Republic of Uzbekistan No. 824, "On measures to improve the system related to the organization of the educational process in higher education institutions," dated December 31, 2020, and its Annex 1, the "Regulation on the procedure for introducing the credit-module system into the educational process in higher educational institutions" (the "Regulation").
2. Decree of the President of the Republic of Uzbekistan No. PF-5847 (October 8, 2019), "On approval of the Concept for the Development of the Higher Education System of the Republic of Uzbekistan until 2030."
3. Decree of the President of the Republic of Uzbekistan No. PF-5953 (March 2, 2020), on the State Program for the Strategy of Actions in Five Priority Areas of Development for 2017-2021.

Since the 2020/2021 academic year, the credit-module system based on the European Credit Transfer and Accumulation System (ECTS) has been phased into the university's educational process, following the six-stage schedule in the Regulation's annex (Section 8).

2. Key Definitions

As defined in Chapter 2 of the Regulation:

Term	Definition
Credit	A unit of measurement of the learning load a student masters in a subject, based on learning outcomes; expressed in whole or fractional numbers.
Study load (student workload)	The number of hours a student needs to achieve the expected learning outcomes across all forms of educational activity - lectures, practical classes, seminars, laboratory work, course projects, internships, and independent work.
GPA (Grade Point Average)	The weighted average of a student's grades across a program, weighted by each subject's/module's credits (formula in Section 4).
Educational element	A type of teaching within the educational program that contributes to learning outcomes and the knowledge specified in the program.
Module/subject program (syllabus)	The working program developed for each subject, specifying its learning outcomes, credit allocation, and assessment criteria.
Academic mobility	Movement of a student to another higher education institution, within the republic or abroad, for a defined period, with credits recognized on return.
Credit accumulation / transfer	Accumulating credit units earned through education, and recognizing credits earned at one institution toward a qualification at another.
Transcript	A prescribed-format document listing subjects with the credits and grades (in letters and numbers) earned in a period of study.

3. Calculation of Student Workload

Item 15 of the Regulation sets the parameters below. Module coordinators must use them when computing workload and allocating credits, and the university council fixes the exact figures within these ranges and publishes them on the university website.

Hours per credit. 1 credit corresponds to an average of 25-30 academic hours of study load.

Classroom vs. independent-work split:

Degree level	Classroom hours	Independent-work hours
Bachelor's	40-50%	50-60%
Master's (excluding internships and graduation projects)	30-40%	60-70%

Credit load per period. 30 credits per semester; 60 credits per academic year, for both undergraduate and graduate programs.

Total credits required for a degree:

Degree	Minimum duration	Total credits
Bachelor's	3 years	180
Bachelor's	4 years	240
Master's	1 year	60
Master's	2 years	120

Academic year structure. Up to 36 weeks: 30 weeks of instruction, 2 weeks for subject-selection registration, and 4 weeks for certification (examination) periods, unless the university council sets a different schedule.

Faculty and module coordinators must express each subject's credit value consistently with these ratios when drafting or revising subject programs (syllabi).

4. GPA Calculation

GPA is the credit-weighted average of a student's grades across all subjects/modules in the reporting period (Regulation, Chapter 2, item 4):

$$GPA = \frac{K_1U_1 + K_2U_2 + K_3U_3 + \dots}{K_1 + K_2 + K_3 + \dots}$$

where:

- **K** - the number of credits allocated to each subject/module;
- **U** - the grade the student earns in each subject/module.

Worked example. A student completes three subjects in a semester: 5 credits at a grade of 4.0, 3 credits at 3.5, and 4 credits at 5.0.

$$GPA = (5 \times 4.0 + 3 \times 3.5 + 4 \times 5.0) / (5 + 3 + 4) = (20 + 10.5 + 20) / 12 = 50.5 / 12 = 4.21$$

GPA also governs course progression (Section 7): the university council sets the minimum passing GPA for advancing to the next course within the range 2.4-3.0.

5. Faculty Responsibilities

Faculty members responsible for a subject or module must:

1. Ensure a constructive alignment between the learning outcomes stated in the curriculum, the teaching methods used, and the assessment process (item 10) - the core quality requirement for every educational program.
2. Advise students, alongside the group mentor and the Educational-Methodological Department, on building and adjusting their personal learning trajectories, and explain how prior achievements and experience can be recognized (item 8).
3. Deliver introductory presentations on their subjects to first-year students before subject registration opens (item 40).
4. Apply the assessment criteria and methods set out in their subject's working program (syllabus) consistently and transparently (item 31), and report grades and credit awards to the registration service for the student's transcript.
5. Keep subject programs current with the model curriculum, subject catalog, and relevant national/international literature on which they are based (item 13).

Where students are given the opportunity to choose among professors or teachers for a subject, faculty must support the one-week online registration window the university sets for this at the start of the semester (item 17).

6. Module Syllabus (Working Program) Requirements

Each subject/module's working program (syllabus) must specify, at minimum:

1. **Learning outcomes** - at least six indicators per educational element, aligned with the curriculum (item 6).
2. **Credit allocation** - the number of credits assigned to the subject, consistent with the university's approved hours-per-credit and classroom/independent-work ratios (Section 3).
3. **Workload breakdown** - the classroom hours (lectures, practicals, seminars, laboratory work) and independent-work hours that make up the subject's total study load.
4. **Assessment criteria and methods** - the forms of assessment used (written, oral, practical, project, portfolio, test) and how they map to the stated learning outcomes (item 31).
5. **Positive-grade threshold** - the grade required for the student to be awarded the subject's credits; credits are not awarded if the required learning outcomes are not achieved (item 30).

Subject programs, the curriculum, and the full catalog of subjects (including elective subjects) must be published on the university website in a downloadable format at least one month before the start of the academic year (item 9).

7. Assessment Criteria

- **Basis.** All students are assessed within their educational program, regardless of study form, based on assessment criteria set by the Ministry of Higher and Secondary Specialized Education (item 29).
- **Methods.** Written, oral, practical work, projects, portfolios, and tests - the method chosen must reflect and confirm the student's achievement of the subject's stated learning outcomes (item 31).
- **Credit awarding.** Credits are granted only when the student achieves the assessed, positive grade set in the subject program. No credit is awarded if the specified learning outcomes are not achieved (item 30).
- **Attendance rule.** A student missing 25% or more of a subject's classroom hours without valid reason is excluded from that subject, barred from its final examination, and treated as not having earned its credits - creating an academic debt (item 41).
- **Credit conversion and transfer.** Recognition and transfer of credits between institutions, including during academic mobility, is based on

comparing each institution's grade-conversion table against the receiving institution's own table (item 32).

- **Course progression.** Transfer from one course to the next is based on GPA, with the university council setting the minimum passing GPA within the range 2.4-3.0 (item 42); students with academic debt are not expelled, but repeat only the subjects owed, paying the corresponding contract fee.

8. Implementation and Communication Directives

To ensure faculty and students apply this framework consistently, the Vice-Rector for Academic Affairs directs the following:

- **Methodological materials.** The Educational-Methodological Department will prepare and maintain a standardized methodological slide deck and briefing materials explaining credit calculation and workload distribution, for use in faculty meetings, department briefings, and first-year student orientation.
- **Institutional guidance documents.** This directive and its companion presentation constitute the university's official guidance on credit-module workload; department heads must ensure module coordinators and group mentors are briefed on their contents before each academic year's registration period.

Responsible units:

Unit	Role
Educational-Methodological Department	Publishes the curriculum, subject catalog, and syllabi; verifies credit/workload consistency across subject programs.
Registration service	Manages student registration, personal learning trajectories, transcripts, and academic-rating records.
Group mentors	Guide students in building and adjusting personal learning trajectories each academic year.

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Unit	Role
Faculty / module coordinators	Apply workload calculations and assessment criteria within their subjects (Sections 5-7).

Phased rollout (Regulation annex, six stages):

Stage	Focus	Responsible	Timing
1	Adapt and approve curricula/subject programs; distribute credits per subject; publish subject catalog	Higher education institution	Before the start of the school year
2	Admit 1st-year bachelor's/master's students under the credit system	Higher education institution	Before the start of the school year
3	Define each student's personal learning trajectory	Higher education institution	From 2020/2021, before each academic year
4	Organize mobility: partner agreements, mobility windows, mobility programs	Institution, ministries/departments	From 2020/2021, ongoing
5	Ensure quality: accreditation agreements and	Institution, ministries/departments	From 2021/2022, ongoing

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Stage	Focus	Responsible	Timing
	accreditation of the credit-module system		
6	Issue internationally recognized diplomas	Higher education institution	At program completion, from 2022

Publication deadline. Per item 9 of the Regulation, all workload, curriculum, and syllabus information must be posted on the university website at least one month before each academic year begins.

9. References

- Resolution of the Cabinet of Ministers of the Republic of Uzbekistan No. 824, "On measures to improve the system related to the organization of the educational process in higher education institutions," Tashkent, December 31, 2020.
 - Annex 1: Regulation on the procedure for introducing the credit-module system into the educational process in higher educational institutions (Chapters 1-9).
 - Annex to Annex 1: Scheme for the phased introduction of the credit-module system (six stages).
 - Annex 2: Additions to Resolution No. 967 of December 3, 2019, "On the gradual transition of higher education institutions to a self-financing system."
- Decree of the President of the Republic of Uzbekistan No. PF-5847, "On approval of the Concept for the Development of the Higher Education System of the Republic of Uzbekistan until 2030," October 8, 2019.
- Decree of the President of the Republic of Uzbekistan No. PF-5953, "On the State Program for the Implementation of the Strategy of Actions in Five Priority Areas of Development of the Republic of Uzbekistan in 2017-2021," March 2, 2020.

Companion material: a methodological slide deck summarizing Sections 3-8 for faculty and student briefings.